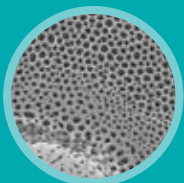


SCIENCE IS THE PATH TO KNOWLEDGE, AND FINDING OUT ABOUT HOW OUR UNIVERSE WORKS. YOU CAN'T BE A GEEK AND NOT KNOW YOUR SCIENCE!

THIS MONTH IN SCIENCE:

This month in science we look at the accomplishments of NASA's DART Mission, and take a deep dive into the growing problem of the presence of microplastics.



Splendid indeed

A recent study titled, Hexagonal Voronoi pattern detected in the microstructural design of the echinoid skeleton, has revealed a special pattern in sea urchin skeletons that could open gates to the development of light-weight yet extremely sturdy materials. <https://dgit.in/SpId>

WHAT'S NEW

NASA's Hubble captures spectacular pair of interacting galaxies

NASA's Hubble Space Telescope has captured a stunning pair of two face-on galaxies, providing spectacular views of their spiral arms, background stars and galaxies. The two interacting galaxies, making up the pair known as 'Arp-Madore 608-333', seem to float side by side in this image from the Hubble Space Telescope. The interacting galaxies are part of an effort to build up an archive of interesting targets for more detailed future study with Hubble, ground-based telescopes, and the NASA/ESA/CSA James Webb Space Telescope. To build up this archive, astronomers scoured existing astronomical catalogues for a list of targets



spread throughout the night sky. They hoped to include objects already identified as interesting and that would be easy for Hubble to observe no matter which direction it was pointing.

<https://dgit.in/NASHubb>

Indian startups to soon launch Space Satellites

On the occasion of the first anniversary of the Indian Space Association (ISpA), Jitendra Singh, Union Minister for the Ministry of Science and Technology, said Indian startups will soon be able to launch space satellites and satellite constellations and experiment with their rocket technology. Indian Space Association (ISpA) celebrated its first anniversary recently. While speaking at the India Space Conclave in Delhi,



the Union Minister stated that startups and private players led by ISRO could revolutionize India's space technology. In addition, HAL and L&T are domestically producing five PSLVs. Also, with the help of

ISRO and NSIL, OneWeb is all set to launch its satellite. Hence, integrating R&D with academia and industry has benefited the country's space sector. 102 startups in India are currently working on space debris management, nano-satellite, launch vehicle, ground systems, research, etc. Jitendra Singh elaborated that ISpA has been an important link between the key stakeholders.

<https://dgit.in/IndSat>



First star is born

NASA's flagship telescope that hasn't failed to gather headlines since its launch, in another staggering discovery, has spotted the earliest stars that have been seen so far. These stars are said to be born 800 million years ago, and are a part of a dense group that surrounds the Sparkler galaxy. <https://dgit.in/StarBorn>



Fishers are back!

Also known as "tree Wolverines", Fishers, a group of tree-climbing carnivores have finally come back to Washington's forests after 14 long years. The efforts that began in 2016, have finally paid off, as the population of Fishers reached an all time high. <https://dgit.in/FishTree>



Green lakes

As if climate change hadn't caused enough problems and issues for everyone dwelling on this planet, a recent research study published in the journal Geophysical Research Letters has revealed that climate change could turn green or browning due to the changing climatic conditions. <https://dgit.in/ColorChg>